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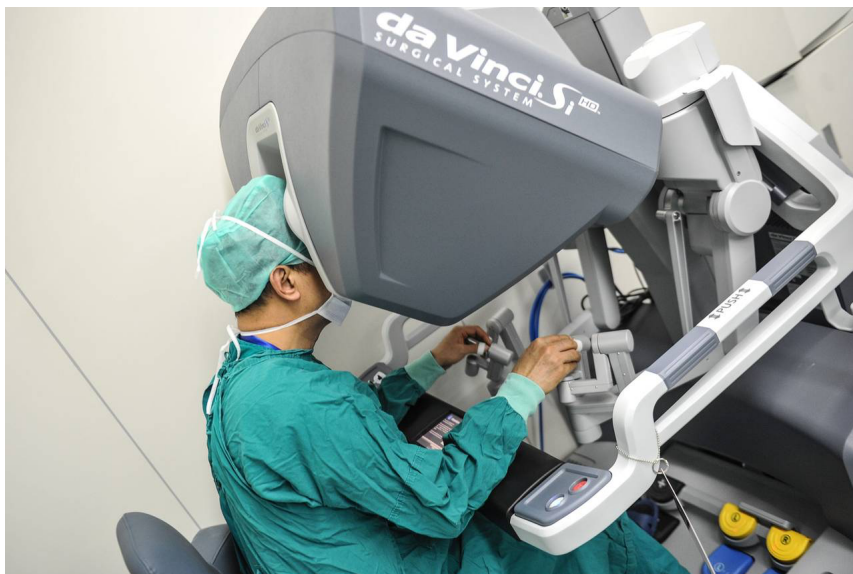
BUSINESS • EARNINGS

Intuitive Surgical Tops Expectations

Company says world-wide sales of its da Vinci surgical system grew in the latest quarter

By Lisa Beilfuss

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Intuitive Surgical, maker of the da Vinci surgical system, said sales grew 16% world-wide in the latest quarter.

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Intuitive Surgical Inc., **ISRG 1.51%** ▲ a maker of robotic systems that enable minimally-invasive surgery, easily topped second-quarter expectations, thanks to solid demand in the U.S. for its systems.

Shares climbed 4.9% to \$704.95 in after-hours trading. Through Tuesday's close, the stock has gained 23% this year. The Sunnyvale, Calif., company is known for its da Vinci surgical system that combines a three-dimensional vision system with tiny wristed instruments.

In its latest quarter, Intuitive Surgical said world-wide da Vinci sales grew about 16% as it shipped 130 systems, up from 118 systems in the year-ago period. The company attributed the gains to a rising number of U.S. surgical procedures and reported higher world-wide urologic procedures.

The double-digit rise in da Vinci sales pushed total revenue 14% higher during the quarter, to \$670.1 million. Service revenue increased about 13% to \$128 million.

The company reported a profit of \$184.5 million, or \$4.71 a share, up from \$134.5 million, or \$3.56 a share, a year earlier. Excluding a tax adjustment, litigation charges and other items, per-share profit rose to \$5.62 from \$4.57 a share.

Analysts projected \$4.97 in adjusted earnings per share on \$640.7 million in revenue, according to Thomson Reuters.

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